CANTON DEV FUND STRATEGY

DPM Debug: Grant Proposal Strategy

Analysis of approved Canton Dev Fund proposals and a strategy for Lazer's first grant submission, a visual debugging plugin for Daml.

Lazer Technologies · Internal Strategy Deck · April 2026

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PART 1: APPROVED PROPOSALS

What the Foundation Has Funded

Eight approved PRs from the Canton Dev Fund, analyzed at $0.15 per CC.

PR	PROPOSAL	PROPOSER	CC AMOUNT	USD VALUE	TIMELINE
#159	**CCTools Community Toolkit**	0xScoutr	500,000	**$75,000**	5 months
#130	**Daml Package Analyzer**	Certora	2,010,000	**$301,500**	5 months
#53	**ISS-Based BFT Ordering**	Digital Asset	Undisclosed	**Est. $500K+**	8 months
#49	**Daml OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	**$150,000/mo**	Recurring
#48	**Canton OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	2,000,000/mo	**$300,000/mo**	Recurring
#47	**Splice OS Maintenance**	Digital Asset	1,000,000/mo	**$150,000/mo**	Recurring
#32	**Daml3 Training Program**	Obsidian Systems	5,290,000	**$740,600**	34 weeks
#24	**Multi-VM Canton (EVM)**	Zenith	2,000,000/mo	**$300,000/mo**	12 months

How They Structured Milestones

CC

CCTools (#159)

3 milestones, front-loaded: 200K CC (40%) in M1 for core learn-to-earn platform. 175K for infra and DeFi dashboard. 125K for API and mobile PWA.

Certora (#130)

4 milestones, back-loaded: 335K CC each for M1 and M2 (build + initial adoption). 670K each for M3 and M4 (tied to 5+ production deployments each).

Obsidian (#32)

4 milestones over 34 weeks. 5,290,000 CC total (revised down 20% from original $927K ask). Modules, certification exams, and 12 coding videos.

DA Maintenance

PRs #47, #48, #49: rolling monthly milestones. 1M to 2M CC/mo for ongoing repo maintenance. Acceptance: response times, release cadence, PR reviews.

What Gets Approved and Why

STRUCTURE
3 to 5 Milestones

Fixed-scope projects use 3 to 5 milestones with explicit, testable acceptance criteria. Not vague deliverables, but conditions like "5 production deployments" or "API accessible with validator tier active."

FRAMING
Public Good Infra

Every approved proposal is framed as public-good infrastructure or core protocol work. Dapps and use-case demos are borderline. Open-source licensing (MIT or Apache 2.0) is table stakes.

CHAMPIONS
Named Sponsor

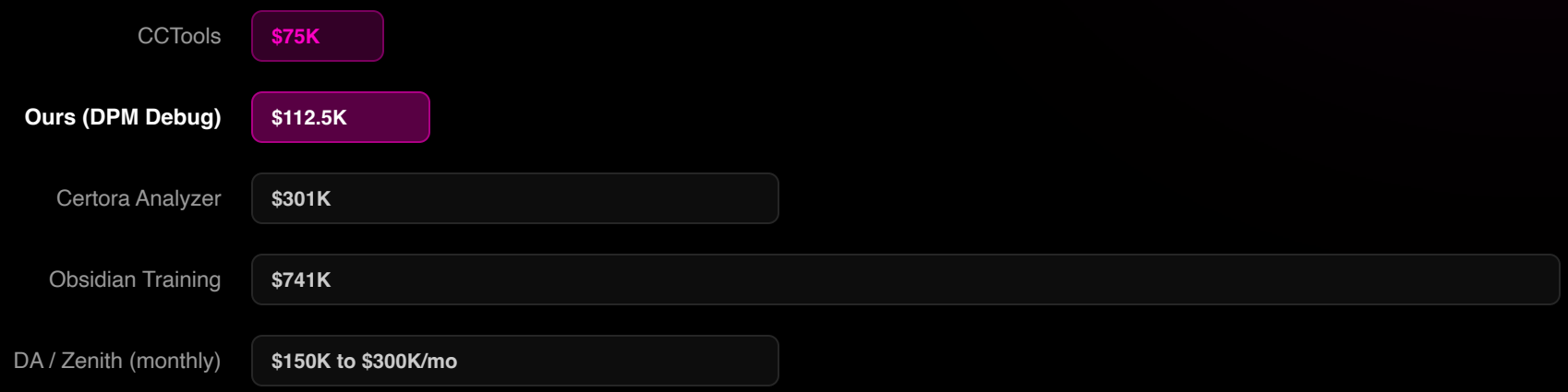
Every proposal has a champion from the Foundation or committee. Jatin Pandya offered to champion ours and review drafts before submission.

CREDIBILITY
Prove It First

CCTools had 20K users before applying. Obsidian voluntarily cut scope by 20%. The strongest proposals show cost discipline and traction, not just ambition.

Grant Budget Landscape

Where our $112.5K ask sits relative to approved proposals.



- **$112.5K is modest and credible** for a first proposal. Above the floor, well below specialized tooling asks. 80% unlocked in the first two milestones.

PART 3: OUR OPPORTUNITY

Why a Debugger, Why Now

> *"A really, really good debugging experience is what lacks on top of Canton. If you ask me personally what I would love to see in the ecosystem, I would say a really good debugging experience."*
>
> **Jatin Pandya, Canton Foundation**
> Call with Lazer, April 14, 2026

- **Foundation DX survey** flagged "visual debugging" and "transaction visibility" as top missing tools
- **Jatin offered to champion** our proposal and review drafts before submission

NO OVERLAP WITH EXISTING PROPOSALS

Certora = Compile-Time Static Analysis
Security auditing of .dar files. Finds potential issues before deployment.

Ours = Runtime Dev Debugging
Visual transaction trees, structured test output, debug logs. Helps developers during active development.

DA Maintenance = Keeps DPM Working
We extend DPM with a plugin. Adds capability, doesn't duplicate effort.

Obsidian = Training Content
Educational modules. Our tooling makes learning-by-doing faster.

PART 4: BUDGET AND MILESTONES

Proposed Grant Structure

$250/hr, 12 weeks, 3 milestones. 80% unlocked in M1 and M2.

DURATION
12 weeks

GRANT ASK
750,000 CC (~$112.5K)

PAYOUT
Milestone-based in CC

MILESTONE	FOCUS	DURATION	CC	USD
M1	DPM plugin scaffold, structured CLI test output, assertion diffs, source linking	5 weeks	**300,000**	**$45,000**
M2	Visual transaction tree (web UI), debug/trace log panel, filter and search	5 weeks	**300,000**	**$45,000**
M3	Snapshot/replay, end-to-end docs, walkthrough video, 1.0 release	2 weeks	**150,000**	**$22,500**
Total		**12 weeks**	**750,000**	**$112,500**

12-Week Delivery Timeline

	WK 1-2	WK 3-4	WK 5-6	WK 7-8	WK 9-10	WK 11-12
M1: Plugin + CLI 300,000 CC ($45K)	SCAFFOLD	PARSER	TEST OUTPUT			
M2: Visual Debugger 300,000 CC ($45K)				WEB UI	TX TREE	
M3: Polish + Release 150,000 CC ($22.5K)						1.0 RELEASE
Champion Reviews Jatin Pandya	ONGOING FEEDBACK + ACCEPTANCE REVIEWS					

DELIVERABLES

- DPM Plugin
- CLI Debugger
- Web UI
- Snapshot/Replay
- Docs + Video
- MIT License

PART 5: DIFFERENTIATION

Why This Wins

Builds on DPM

Jatin specifically recommended this architecture. Extends the tool the Foundation already funds (PR #49) rather than duplicating infrastructure.

#1 Cited Gap

The Foundation's own DX survey and Jatin's direct feedback both identify visual debugging as the single biggest missing piece in the Daml developer experience.

Complementary

Runtime debugging (ours) complements Certora's compile-time static analysis. Different layer, different users, zero overlap.

Credible First Ask

$112.5K ($10K/week over 12 weeks) covers our full $250/hr rate, with 80% unlocked in M1 and M2. Positions Lazer for larger follow-up proposals after we deliver.